

1938, December 15

The following is a faithful transcription of the typewritten original by the Servant of God, Father Solanus Casey, O.F.M. Cap.

Rev. M. E. Joachim Casey, page 3.

As, dear Maurice; if, "what we do for our own souls is 100% for the glory of God, then surely we don't need to go far for mission work. After all, we have just one soul--and only--that we must save. Should we in the end save everyone else in the whole world and not save our own soul, what would it profit us? (What wretchedly poor work! Interrupted again and again: I'd do it all over had I another day. Deo Gratias!

O Brother Dear! Why are we all so stupid? We are all alike in a way. We worry our heads and our hearts about many things like Martha and almost totally undervalue the invitation--most beautiful of all--"learn of me because I am meek and humble of heart." Mary the Penitent understood it and Jesus praised her for her appreciation.....It seems to me that, were we only to correspond to God's graces, continually being showered down on everyone of us, we would be able to pass from being great sinners one day to be great saints the next.

The following are a few lines from a letter received a day or two back. It is from a one-time leading religious and writer, who seemingly is having a purgatory of things these past few years. "... to the good God who must sorrow even more than I do over this situation, "I have indeed come to know that I am nothing, I have nothing and can do nothing, and all that remains is a tiny flicker of a weak will 'to want' to remain faithful and persevere, no matter what the cost."

I am enclosing a copy of the rhyme-letter you gave to Fr. ex-Provincial two years ago. It will do you good to read it over whenever you be inclined to play with "the blues." Friends of ours here offered to make a number of copies to send to anyone I might wish. Besides this, I came across a description of dear, old Father's death, written shortly after he died. Wishing to get a copy of it before I'd send the original to the oldest of the Family, these friends made copies of it too, one of which I am herewith enclosing. Incidentally, Christmas Eve will be the tenth anniversary of the writer's funeral. R.I.P. I believe you had the Mass, with six of her brothers pall-bearers --two of whom you had the privilege, sad as it must have been, of laying to rest just a month later. R.I.P.

In Corde Jesu,
Fr. Solanus. Oremus Invicem
Deo Gratias